

Certyfikat PMP: Project Risk Planning

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The Dual Nature of Uncertainty

The Risk/Issue Threshold

Point of Occurrence

Uncertainty = Risk

Certainty = Issue

Opportunity
(Positive Impact)

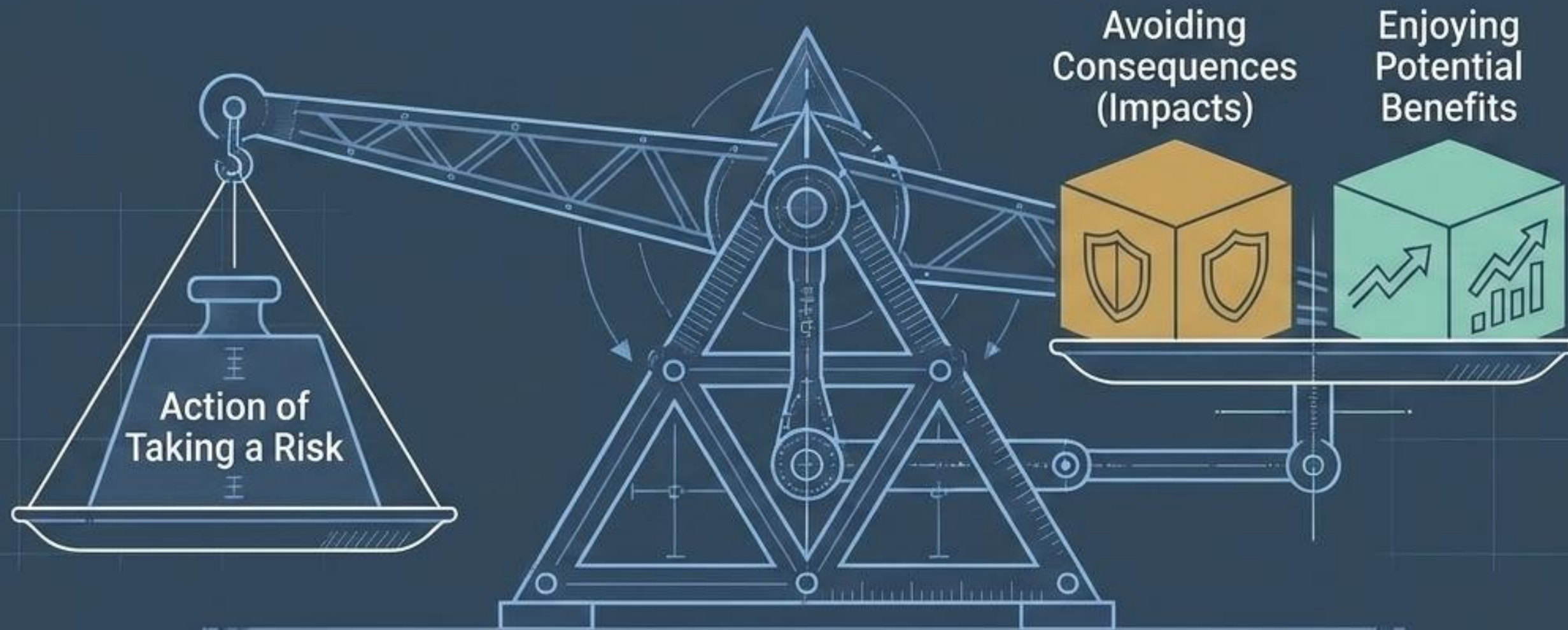
Threat
(Negative Impact)

Risk is evident in everything we do. It is pure uncertainty that can impact project objectives (time, cost, scope, quality).

PMP Exam Rule

According to the PMBOK® Guide, once a risk event occurs, it's considered an issue and is no longer a risk.

The Balancing Act of Planning



The processes that involve risk concern balance. The project manager must find the point where stakeholders are comfortable with the risk based on the benefits they can potentially gain or the consequences they can avoid.

Defining the Rules of Engagement

Key Concept: Plan Risk Management

PMP Exam Spotlight

The PMBOK® Guide contends that this process should begin as soon as the project begins and conclude early in the Planning process.



Initiating

Planning

Executing

Monitoring/Controlling

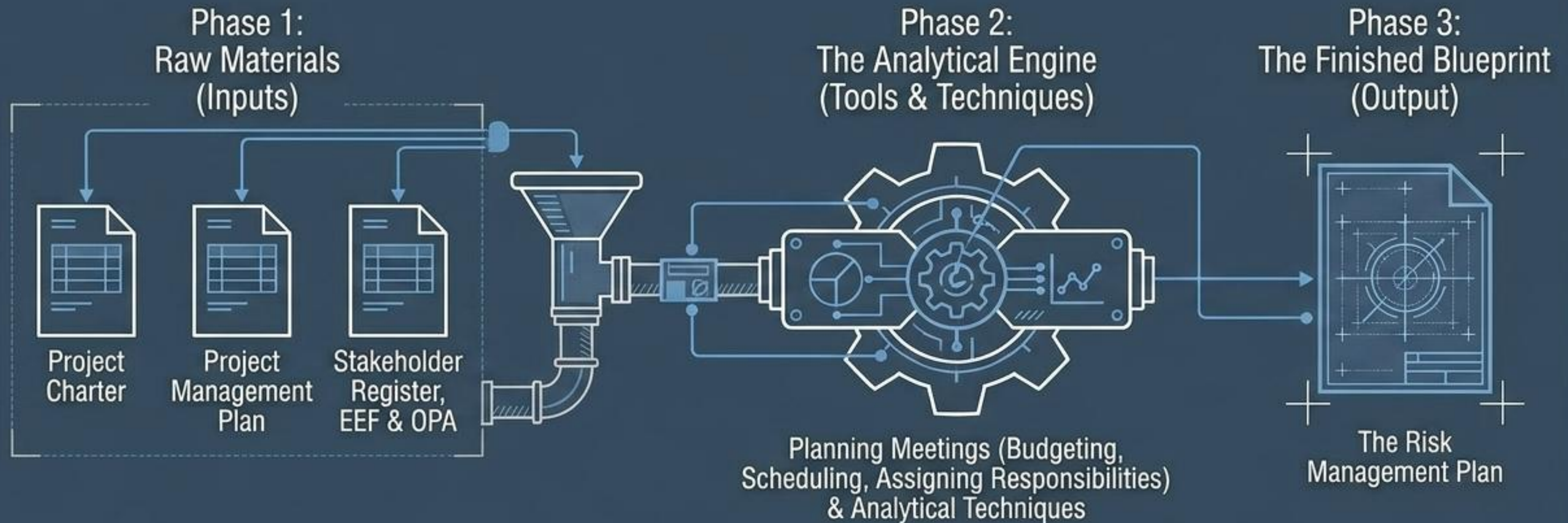
Closing

Rationale: Ensures appropriate resources and time are dedicated based on risk importance. It provides the agreed-upon baseline for all future risk evaluation.

The Stakeholder Risk Attitude

Risk Appetite	Risk Tolerance	Risk Threshold
Definition	Definition	Definition
The level of uncertainty stakeholders are willing to accept for potential positive impacts.	The degree, amount, or volume of risk that an organization or individual will withstand.	The specific point along a continuum where acceptable risk becomes unacceptable.
Focus	Focus	Focus
The desire for Reward vs. Unknowns.	Comfort level with the impact/consequences.	Strict, measurable limits.
PMBOK Example	PMBOK Example	PMBOK Example
Implementing a new inventory system despite employee protests, because the technological benefits outweigh the unknowns.	A 275-pound brute with bodyguards walking down a dark alley (High Tolerance) vs. a petite person alone (Low Tolerance).	A monetary rule stating no risk is accepted if the threat could cost more than 5% of the total project budget.

Forging the Risk Management Plan



The plan defines how to manage risks, but does not attempt to define responses to individual risks yet.

Anatomy of the Risk Management Plan



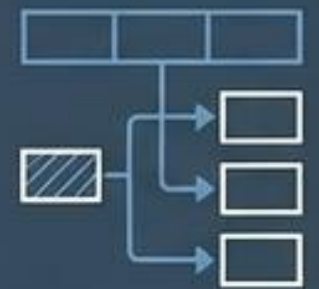
Methodology & Roles

How it's performed and who does it. Analysis should be unbiased; risk teams may differ from project teams.



Budgeting & Timing

Allocating contingency reserves and scheduling risk activities into the project baseline.



Risk Categories

A systematic framework to identify and sort risks.



Probability & Impact Definitions

Establishing the scoring criteria for analysis.



P&I Matrix

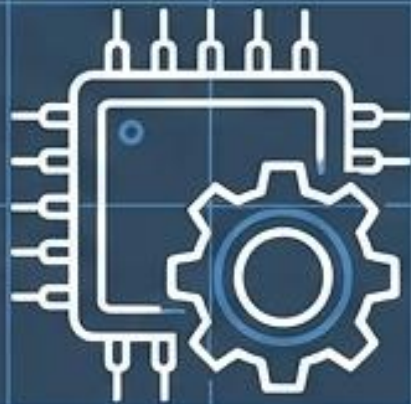
The prioritization grid template.



Reporting & Tracking

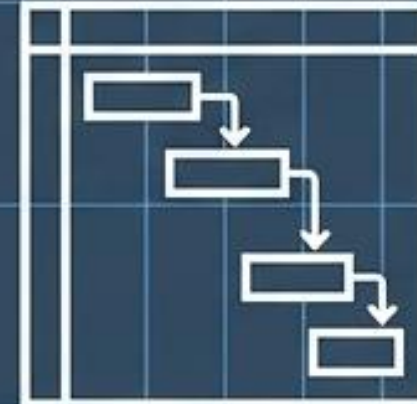
Formatting the risk register and auditing the process.

Structuring the Unknown: Primary Risk Categories



Technical / Quality / Performance

Focus: Unproven technology, complex tech, unrealistic performance goals.



Project Management

Focus: Improper schedule/resource planning, poor methodologies.



Organizational

Focus: Resource conflicts across multiple projects, lack of funding, diverted funds.



External

Focus: Laws, weather, labor issues.

Force majeure (catastrophes) require disaster recovery, not standard risk planning.

The Risk Breakdown Structure (RBS)

A hierarchical representation that provides a common language and foundation for systematically identifying risks.



Setting the Rules: The Probability & Impact Matrix

Probability = The potential for the event occurring.

Probability (Potential to Occur)

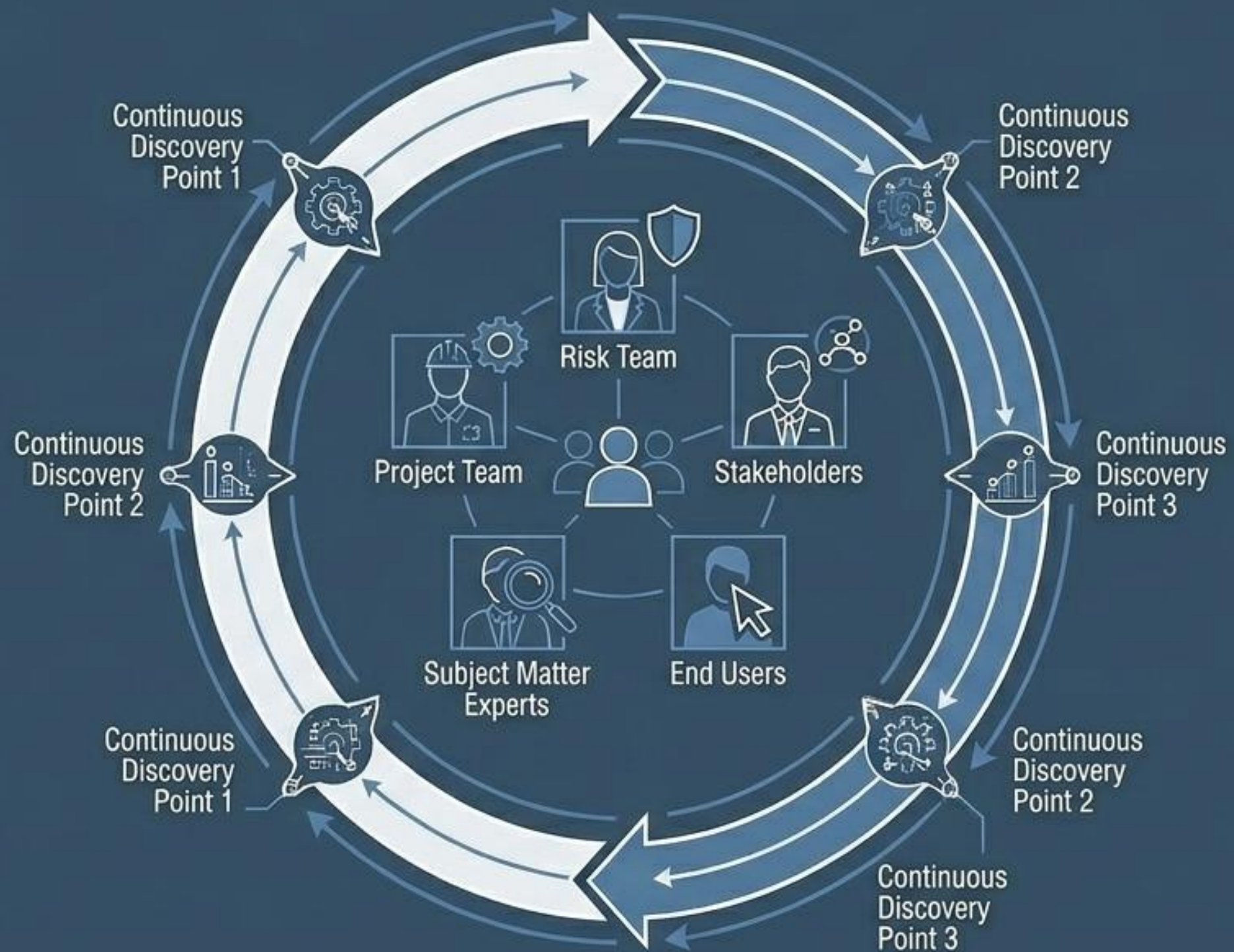
Impact (Consequences on Time/Cost/Scope/Quality)

Impact = The effects on the project objectives.

Crucial Distinction

You do not use this matrix during Plan Risk Management. You define its structure here so it can be used later during the Perform Qualitative Risk Analysis process.

Process 2: Identify Risks



Core Concept

Identify Risks is an iterative process that continually builds on itself as the project progresses.

Who is involved?

Project team, risk team, stakeholders, subject matter experts, and end users.

Call to Action

All project participants should be encouraged to continually watch for and report potential risk events

↓ Sample Threat ↑ Opportunity

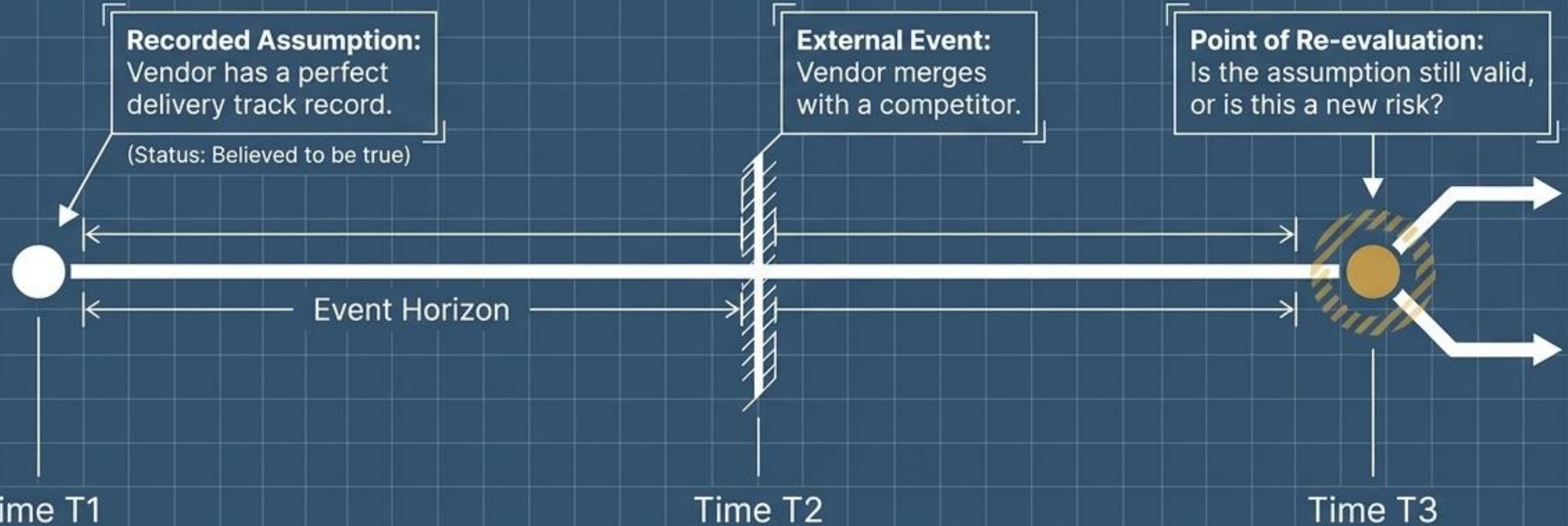
Hunting the Unknown: Sources of Risk



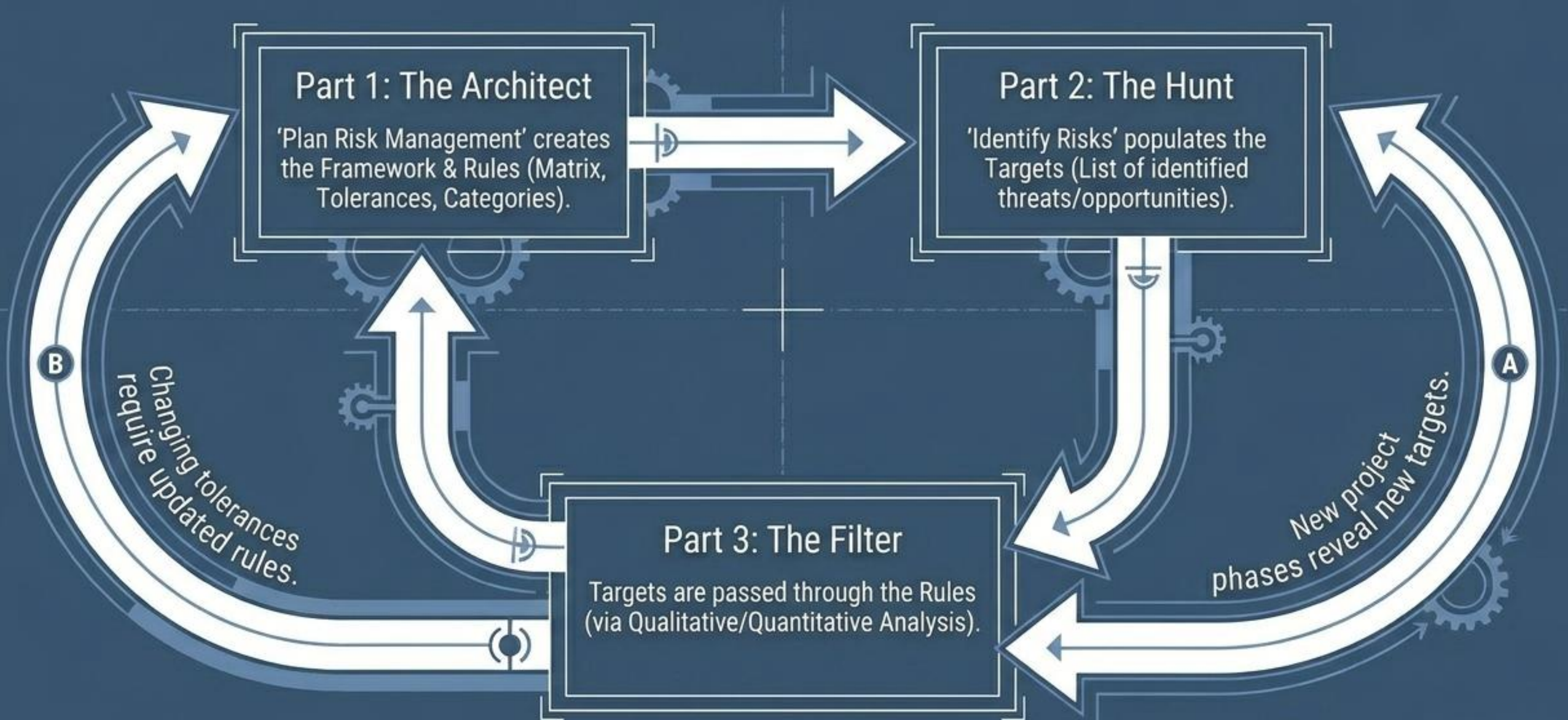
Risk (uncertainty) is lurking almost anywhere. Examine the outputs of most Planning processes to discover it.

The Fragility of Assumptions

Assumptions are recorded early in the project scope statement. They must be continuously re-evaluated. Changing environments can instantly transform a valid assumption into a critical project risk.



The Synthesis Arc: A Self-Sustaining System



Critical PMP® Exam Takeaways

Risk vs. Issue

Risk = **Uncertainty**
(**Threat** or **Opportunity**).

Issue = **Certainty** (The event has occurred).

The Attitude Spectrum

Appetite: Willingness for reward.

Tolerance: Comfort with impact.

Threshold: The strict measurable limit.

Timing & Execution

Plan Risk Management: Done early; sets the baseline rules.

Identify Risks: Done continuously; involves everyone.